

2024-2025

CONSTITUTION OF AFRIKIYA

Organization Motto

The purpose of this organization is to enlighten Furman campus about African history, countries, cities, and the realities of being an African or being from the diaspora. This organization will not tolerate racist comments, discrimination, homophobia, xenophobia and portrayal of stereotypes.

Our gestures, words and behaviors should reflect the grace and beauty of being an African.

We shall be examples for the next generations of Africans enrolling at Furman University and we should not portray negatives stereotypes on campus.

Therefore, I state that AFRICAN TIME IS DEAD!

1. I will be on TIME for meetings
2. I will be consistent
3. I will be intentional
4. I will be THE Example of African leadership
5. I shall not generalize about the continent.
6. I will treat Africa as a CONTINENT and not as a country.

Article I. Name

This organization shall be called and recognized by all as Afrikiya (African club at Furman University).

Article II. Purposes

1. Enlighten the campus community about African history, ancient African cities and prosperous kingdoms.
 - If a member has a problematic behavior, we will address it openly in an emergency meeting
 - If the behavior isn't changed, he/her/they will be ejected from the organization and reported to the SDC office for discrimination
2. Explore African cultures and modern Africa, to include modern cities and scientific research.
3. Engage students in African games, songs, lifestyles, food, sports, movies and other activities.
4. To debunk myths and stereotypes about the continent.
5. To build a bridge between Furman students from Africa and other Furman students in general.

Article III. Membership

1. Furman community interested in learning about Africa and being an ally.
2. To be a club member, one must not have 3 consecutive unexcused absences from club meetings.
3. To be considered for a leadership role you should have a consistent attendance plus the excitement to improve and extend the organization.
4. If there's an emergency or you will fail to attend the meeting, please let the Secretary know of your absence.

Article IV. Officers

PRESIDENT (Upperclassmen)

The president will:

1. Chair all club meetings.
2. Represent the club at events where a delegation or representation is needed.
3. Lead the club during specific trips to specific events across the United States and the world at large.
4. Oversee the other officers of the club, and ensure that each of them performs their functions.
5. Perform any other functions deemed necessary.

VICE PRESIDENT (upperclassmen)

The Vice President will:

1. Perform all the functions of the President in his/her/their absence.
2. Plan club activities, in consultation with other key members.
3. The club's budget will run through him/her/their after being passed on by the treasurer.

Budget committee (President, Vice President, Treasurer, Secretary) will meet to propose allocation then it will be voted by the other members.

TREASURER (Upperclassmen)

The Treasurer shall:

1. Take responsibility for the club's financial transactions. Oversee credit cards, receipts and oversee online orders.
2. Submit a financial report to the club during every periodic meeting.
3. Ensure that the budget of the club is within available resources by checking that the total cost of planned activities does not exceed the amount of money the club has.

SOCIAL MEDIA/MEDIA REPRESENTATIVE (Open to Freshmen)

The media representative shall:

1. Be responsible for managing the different social media account: Instagram, Facebook and group me.
2. Oversee publications throughout campus and Afrikiya online presence. That includes flyers, posters and Instagram posts.
3. Be responsible for advertising the club, its activities, events, and meetings.
4. Manage social media posts and filter the content posted.
5. Appeal to the general student population to join the club.

SECRETARY (Open to Freshmen)

The secretary shall:

1. Record minutes of club meetings
2. Send recap of the meeting minutes by emails and on the club group chat.
3. Be the point of online communication in the different club group chats.
4. Send reminders in the group chat about different deadlines. Therefore, they would have perfect knowledge of the club schedule.
5. Take note of attendance and keep a list of members.

STUDENT OUTREACH OFFICER (Open to Freshmen):

The Student Outreach Officer shall:

1. Connect with students on campus and get them to know about Afrikiya
2. Be present at all club events
3. Engage in public speaking about Afrikiya when necessary.
4. Work closely with social media to promote the Afrikiya.

By-Laws

Article V. Assuming Office

1. None of the members shall assume a position forcefully, or via nomination.
2. Each member shall be voted into his/her respective position through a secret ballot during the second official meeting.
3. A member can only contest for one position during an election.
4. Final written submissions for participation in the elections must be made a week before the elections to the Election Council.
5. An election will take place if 2/3 of the members are present.
6. Each member of the club shall have one vote.
7. A sitting president shall be ineligible to vote. Furthermore, he/she shall NEITHER advise NOR campaign for a specific member in any way.

Article VI. Election Council

1. Shall comprise the club Adviser and any club member, who is not running for election, chosen by the adviser to temporarily assist him/her in conducting an election.
2. The club Adviser will chair this council.
3. Shall oversee the elections within the club.
4. Hear cases regarding the underperformance of officers.

Article VII. Meetings

1. The club shall have the first meeting of the semester on Thursday, the First week after the commencement of every semester at 5:00 PM. The club shall have its first meeting after the first 2 weeks. (Meeting times are subject to change.)
2. Regular club meetings shall be held every 2nd and 4th Thursday of each month at 5:00 PM.
3. Executive members shall meet every 1st and 3rd Sunday of each month or as needed for planning of programs etc.

Article VIII. Member responsibility

Members shall:

1. Act as faces of the club, telling the Furman community what takes place during club meetings.
2. Freely invite members to the club.
3. Not stand out to prefer, one country by deeming it better than the rest in terms of culture and people. Instead, they shall embrace the African continent as a whole and be willing to learn more about its diverse cultures.

Article IX. Recall of officers

1. If an officer or a member breaks any of the stipulated rules or fails to perform their duties, any member can call for an emergency meeting to discuss the specific member's lack of adherence to rules, or their underperformance.
2. The emergency meeting shall be held within five days, and the member in question shall NOT attend this meeting.
3. If three quarters of the members present agree that the member in question needs correction, another meeting shall be held within three days so that the member in question can defend themselves.
4. After the member in question has defended themselves, the election council, excluding the president, must vote for or against recalling the member.
5. If the member holds a position and three quarters vote for recalling him/her, that member need to resign their position.
6. If the member is an ordinary member, then they should be given a warning. If they get three warnings within two consecutive semesters, then they should be expelled from the club.

Article X. Amendments

1. Amendments to this constitution may only be made by a 2/3 majority
2. Proposals for amending the constitution must be debated on the next meeting after they have been made.
3. A vote on the amendment must be made after the debate on the issue.